PIROXICAM

Once daily
High GI risk

CHEMICAL NAME 4-hydroxy-2-methyl-N-(pyridin-2-yl)-2H-1,2-benzothiazine-3-carboxamide 1,1-dioxide

CLASS Non-selective NSAID (oxicam)

TRADE NAMES Feldene · Brexin (β-cyclodextrin) · Roxicam

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Symptomatic relief of osteoarthritis, rheumatoid arthritis and ankylosing spondylitis (second-line).
- Acute musculoskeletal disorders (topical gel).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily with food.
- **IM** for initial treatment in some markets.
- **Topical** gel; **sublingual** melts.

DOSAGES

- **Adult:** 20 mg once daily (max 20 mg/day).
- Elderly: start 10 mg daily.
- Review need after 14 days.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 1 h. **Peak:** 3–5 h.
- Metabolised in liver (CYP2C9).
- Excreted in urine and faeces. **t½:** about 50 h → steady state after 7–12 days.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Inhibits **COX-1 and COX-2** → ↓ prostaglandins.
- Long-lasting anti-inflammatory and analgesic action.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Dyspepsia, nausea, abdominal pain.
- Oedema, dizziness.
- Photosensitivity, rash.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Serious GI bleeding (higher than most NSAIDs).
- Severe skin reactions (SJS/TEN).
- Renal impairment; hepatotoxicity.
- Cardiovascular events.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- History of GI ulcer, bleeding or inflammation.
- Use with other NSAIDs or anticoagulants.
- Severe renal, hepatic or heart failure; NSAID-sensitive asthma.
- Third trimester; history of severe drug skin reactions.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Anticoagulants, SSRIs, steroids, aspirin:** ↑ bleeding.
- **Lithium, methotrexate:** ↑ levels.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Confirm it is not first-line; check for GI risk factors.
- Give with food; consider PPI.
- Monitor for GI bleeding, skin rash, oedema.
- Check renal and liver function in long-term use.
- Assess joint symptoms.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take once daily with food.
- Avoid strong sunlight; use sunscreen.
- Report skin blistering, black stools or abdominal pain.
- Full effect takes about 1–2 weeks.

KEY POINTS

- Oxicam; very long half-life, once daily.
- Second-line for arthritis.
- Higher GI bleeding risk.
- Max 20 mg/day.

SOURCES CHECKED **[20]** PIROXICAM CAPSULES 10 mg (UK SmPC) **[21]** Piroxicam, oral (US label) **[22]** Piroxicam, oral (US label, Bryant Ranch Prepack)

Full references p. 432–457